

VORTEX - Virtual Overlay for Reimagined Tabletop EXperience - Instructions

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December 2023

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1 Download and Installation

1.1 For the first time downloading

1. Download the zip file from github using the download link
2. unzip the folder where the adventurer prefers
3. unzip the libcef zipped file and place the libcef.dll file in the same directory with VORTEX.exe

1.2 Updating

1. Download the zip file from github using the download link
2. unzip the folder at a different location to the adventurer's current VORTEX folder
3. Copy and paste all of the contents from the updated folder into the old folder, overwriting the old contents

2 First Time User

Start by opening the program VORTEX.exe, then select **cancel** when prompted to load a file.

The default blank template will load, and the user will be prompted to enter the character's name, then level. The adventurer's proficiency bonus will be automatically calculated from here, but can still be customised later on if needed. (Sometimes the pop up for name does not appear and the adventurer need to find it in the taskbar.)

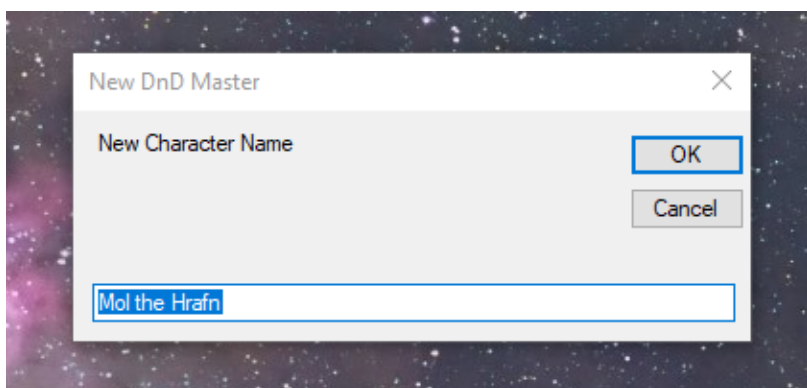


Figure 1:

VORTEX will start with the **Instructions** page. There is a checkbox list to complete the adventurer's character sheet. Selecting an entry in the checkbox will temporarily highlight the relevant part of VORTEX and provide a short list of instructions. More detailed instructions are given in this document at the relevant sections. Whenever the adventurer is done inputting into a section, feel free to tick this checkbox list. Even if the adventurer doesn't, nothing bad will happen.

2.1 DND Attributes

VORTEX assumes DND 5e stat block, STRENGTH, DEXTERITY, CONSTITUTION, INTELLIGENCE, WISDOM, and CHARISMA. To input the adventurer's character stats, right click on the coloured box. This will load up a secondary window. The relevant parts on each of the steps below are highlighted in Figure 2

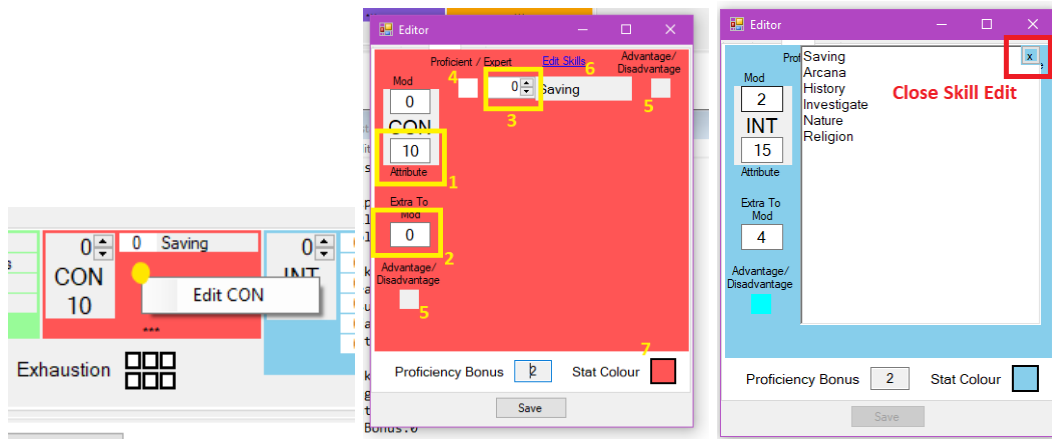


Figure 2:

1. Enter the adventurer's Score for the attribute, the Modifier will update accordingly.
2. Any bonuses to the modifier should be recorded with the "Extra To Mod" number. These bonuses only take effect once saved and this window closes. The adventurer should notice that the number for the modifier displayed in VORTEX main window (not this edit window) to be Blue = Positive bonus, Red = Negative bonus, Black = Normal.
3. Any bonuses to skill modifiers can be included using the up and down arrows for the corresponding skills. These follow the same colour scheme as step 2 (and does change in this edit window).
4. Clicking the proficiency box changes between WHITE = Not proficient, BLACK = proficient, and GOLD = Expert. This automatically includes the adventurer's proficiency bonus (as shown below, and can be modified later but somewhere else) into the skill.
5. Clicking the advantage/disadvantage box changes between WHITE = normal, BLUE = advantage, and RED = Disadvantage. The box beneath "Extra To Mod" will indicate advantage/disadvantage to the entire attribute, while the boxes to the right of the skill names indicate for that specific skill.
6. Clicking the "Edit Skills" brings up a list of the current skills. Here the adventurer can add or reorder anyhow they prefer. When done, click on the small "x" button at the top right of this list.
7. If the adventurer disagree with my colour scheme, they can always change the colour for the attribute by clicking the button next to "Stat Colour".

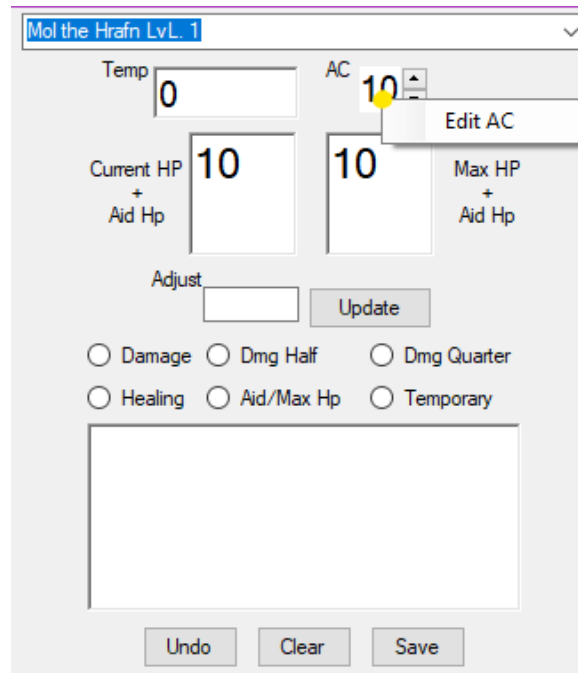


Figure 3:

2.2 HP and AC

VORTEX assumes DND 5e HP system with your normal HP, temporary HP, and spell/item effects that can alter your Maximum HP temporarily.

1. Enter your current and maximum HP into the two relevant boxes. Temporary HP and changes to MAX HP can be entered later (see section 3.2)
2. Right click on the AC value box and “Edit AC” (see Figure 3)
3. Enter your base AC when prompted
4. Any bonuses to AC can be included using the up and down arrows on the program’s AC indicator.

2.3 Other Stats

A lot of the features in DND such as walking speed and carrying capacity are not too important until the adventurer need to find them. These can be listed in this small section of VORTEX. Any temporary changes to these stats can be noted using the small text box next to the corresponding stat.

To Edit the list:

1. Right click anywhere around this section of VORTEX then “Edit Stat”

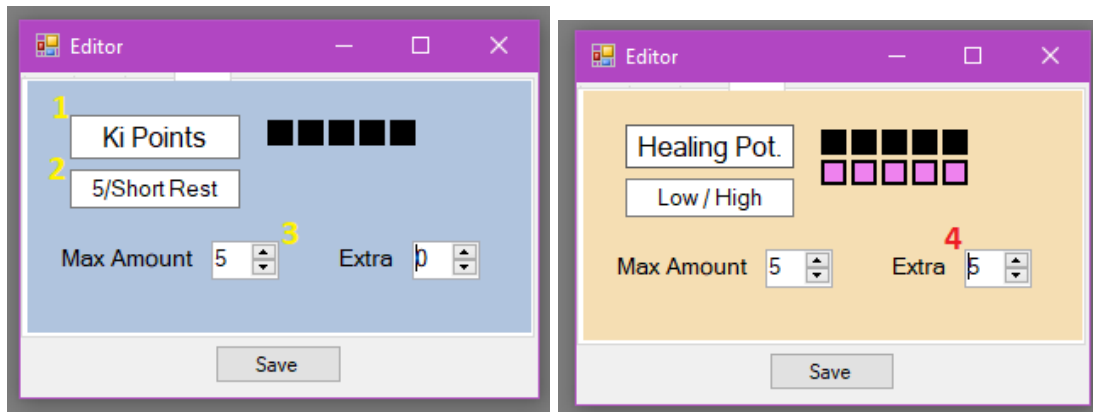


Figure 4:

2. In the list that appeared, the adventurer can modify and reorder the stats freely. Make sure to use the format **Statname : Value**. “+” and “-” symbols are allowed, and the value doesn’t have to be numbers.
3. When done, press the “x” at the top right of the list

Prof. Bonus must be kept with the same spelling and must exist in this section. The adventurer can customise their proficiency bonus value by changing this number.

2.4 Resources and Spell Slots

Across three pages, the adventurer can track their resources in DND with coloured buttons that changes colours as they click on them. The design intent is to have:

- Combat Resources - Track resources that are commonly used in combat, such as Battle Master Fighter - Superiority Dice, Psi Warrior Fighter - Psionic Dice, or Monk’s Ki points.
- Adventuring Resources - Track miscellaneous resources such as rations, potions, torches etc.
- Spell Slots - Track the adventurer’s spell slots!

Of course the adventurer can choose to list their spell slots in the **Combat Resources** page, however by listing them in **Spell Slots** page, the spell casting feature of VORTEX will automatically remove the expended spell slot (see Section 3.10). VORTEX is made with customisability in mind, so do not feel like the adventurer have to stick with any of my conventions.

To Enter a Resource (Figure 4 indicates the steps):

1. Right click anywhere on the page and “Add Resource”. A secondary window will appear with the Hit Dice example.
2. Enter the name and whatever short description the adventurer like.
3. The amount of the resource is indicated by the coloured buttons. To add or subtract buttons, the adventurer use the value inputs. Each entry in the page can fit 15 buttons, exceeding this, the adventurer should create a separate entry but keep the names unique.

4. Extra amounts can be used in a various amount of ways. For example, if the adventurer's campaign has items with the effect of granting additional hit dice separate to their current pool. Or, the adventurer can use it to track two versions of the same type of resource like *Normal rations and high quality rations*.

Once the adventurer have populated the list, they can edit, remove, or reorder the items by right clicking around the page. The adventurer can also change the colour scheme if these coloured buttons (see Section 3.6)

For spell slots, the naming convention has to be 1st Level, 2nd Level, 3rd Level, 4th Level, etc, for it to interact with the spell casting feature

2.5 Actions, Bonus Actions, Reactions

Assuming DND 5e rules, once per turn the player has Actions, Bonus Actions, and a Reaction. Items listed in these 3 pages have format that is designed primarily to handle weapon attacks, but can be versatile and accommodate cantrips, spells, and more. As always, the adventurer don't have to follow the three page format, and can write whatever they want wherever they want.

By default, there are 2 items as examples on how to input them. Click on the example weapon labels to bring up separate windows. To enter a new option:

1. Right click anywhere in the desired page and "Add Item". A secondary window will show up.
2. Start by writing the name. The tooltip is optional.
3. Input the weapon's information by choosing the relevant option in the drop down menu "Add Option". There is Melee, Range, and None (M/R/N). Choosing Melee and Range will allow the weapon's To Hit modifier to interact with some features (see Section 3.8).
4. The new row that appears have the format of **DESCRIPTION — TO HIT — DAMAGE — M/R/N**.
5. "Add Quiver" adds a new row underneath the weapon option. This is another way to track weapon resources, such as for a quiver of 20 steel bolts, an inventory of 3 hunting nets, or even three 1st level spell slots uses of Cure Wounds.

Save when done. To edit any items, click on the name of the item/weapon. To remove, right click and "Remove Item" or go into the editing window and select "Remove". To reorder, right click and "Reorder".

The only necessary parts to write in the input/edit windows are the name and M/R/N. Everything else does not have a strict format. This allows for actions without a To Hit, or actions without any damage. The adventurer can therefore write the DC to land a spell in the to hit section, or effects like stunned and restrained in the damage section.

2.6 Owlbear

The purpose of VORTEX is to eliminate alt-tabbing while playing DND online. Mol plays on Owlbear Rodeo, but the 'integration' of the Virtual Table Top (VTT) is just a simple webpage. Therefore the adventurer can technically run any VTT and any websites with VORTEX.

- To initialise VORTEX with a VTT, head to the OwlBear page, enter the link to the Owlbear room at the long text box and click launch.

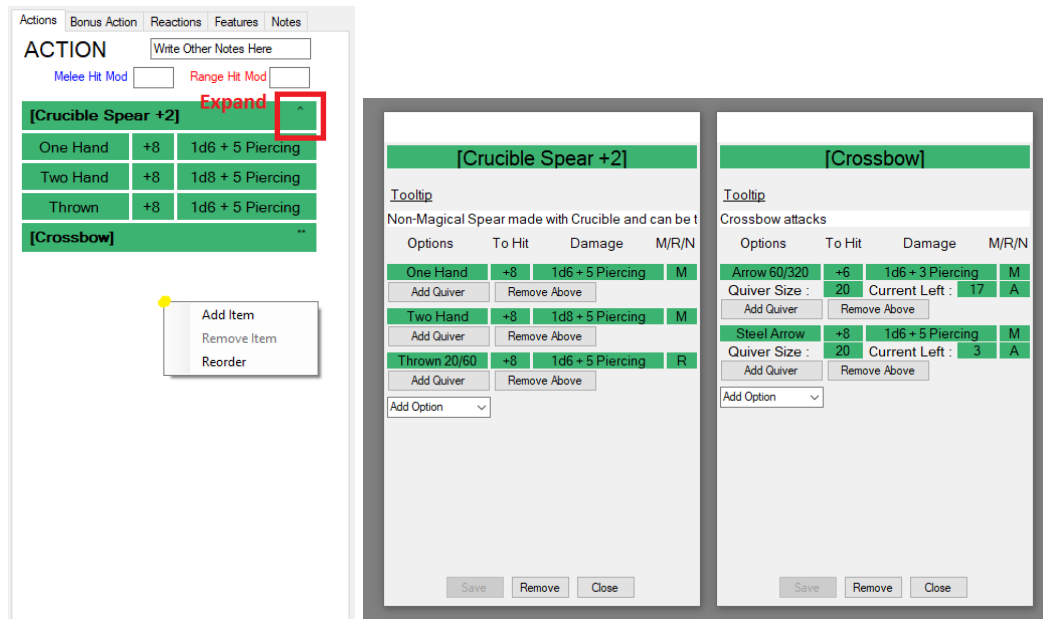


Figure 5:

- Once loaded, the link entered will become the default link and will be automatically launched the next time the adventurer load up VORTEX
- To exit this link at any time, use the “x” button at the top right of this page.
- To edit the link, exit the previous link then enter the new one and launch it.

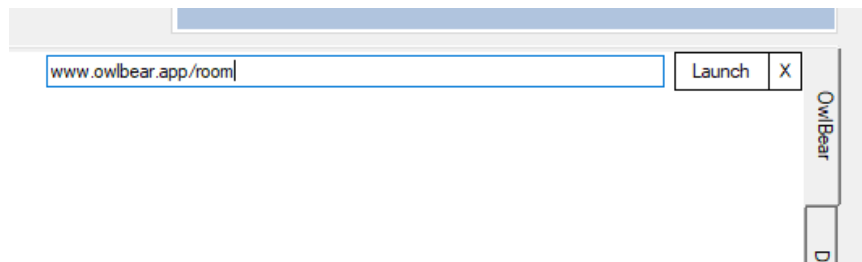


Figure 6:

VORTEX is not your web browser and therefore is unable to remember login details. If you have an owlbear account, you have to login manually every time. If your account is made via Google for example, I suggest login by entering your email address and email password into owlbear. If you login via google, you will be asked to authorise your google account every single time.

2.7 Equipment

Each box in this page is an item slot. To enter items into the Equipment page:

1. Click on one of the grey boxes. A secondary window will appear
2. Enter the name of the item. The short description is a tooltip and is optional
3. Enter the long description however desired. Avoid “|”, “:”, and “^”. These symbols are used in the coding syntax and will be automatically changed into “-” and “*”. Multiple lines and paragraphs are fine.
4. The adventurer can resize the window like a normal window. They can also resize the font with the “+” and “-” buttons.
5. Choose a colour for the item with the square box above the “+” and “-” buttons

Once saved, the item slot will turn into a box with the item name and colour. Clicking on this box brings up its card where the adventurer can edit or remove the item from the item slot. To create/remove/reorder item slots, right click anywhere in the page. The adventurer can only remove an item slot that doesn't have an item written on it.

2.8 Spells Known

VORTEX has every DND 5e spells (except UA) in its library. Each box is a slot to record a spell, similar to Equipments.

To input a spell via the library:

1. Right click at one of the slot for spells (grey boxes)
2. Navigate the drop down menu to get to the spell the adventurer want and select it. They can also use the search spell function
3. Once a spell is selected, the initial box will turn into a box with that spell. Click on that to do some minor edits such as To Hit modifier, DC, and colour
4. When prompted with upcasting information, press OK for the default values

To input a spell manually:

1. Click on one of the slots for spells (grey boxes)
2. Enter the information of the spell in the corresponding text boxes
3. Choose the damage dice of the spell with the slider
4. Save when happy with everything
5. Upcast information (a pop-up window, see Figure 7) will appear. **READ below this carefully.**

If cantrip, there is no upcast information, enter “-”. For levelled spells, it is important to get this right for the spell casting functionality. The adventurer need to provide 3 numbers, separated by “-”.

- The first is how many more dice does the adventurer roll when the spell is affected by upcasting. Spells like Fireball adds 1d6 per upcasted level, so the first number is 1. Spells like Flame Blade adds 1d6 per 2 levels upcasted, so the first number is still 1. Vitriolic Sphere adds 2d4 per level upcasted, so the first number is 2. Any other spells without a damage dice or where damage is not effected by upcasting, or the dice is not effected by upcasting, the first number is 0.
- The second number is the minimum level of spell slot required to cast the spell. Fireball is level 3, so the second number is 3. Flame Blade is 2, so the number is 2.
- The last number is the levels required to upcast before the dice increase has effect. Fireball is 1d6 per level upcasted, so the number is 1. Flame Blade is 1d6 per 2 levels upcasted, so the number is 2. For any spells without dice changes form upcasting, this number can just be 1.
- For example, Fireball upcasting information is '1-3-1', Flame blade '1-2-2', Vitriolic Sphere '2-4-1', and spells like Haste '0-3-1'

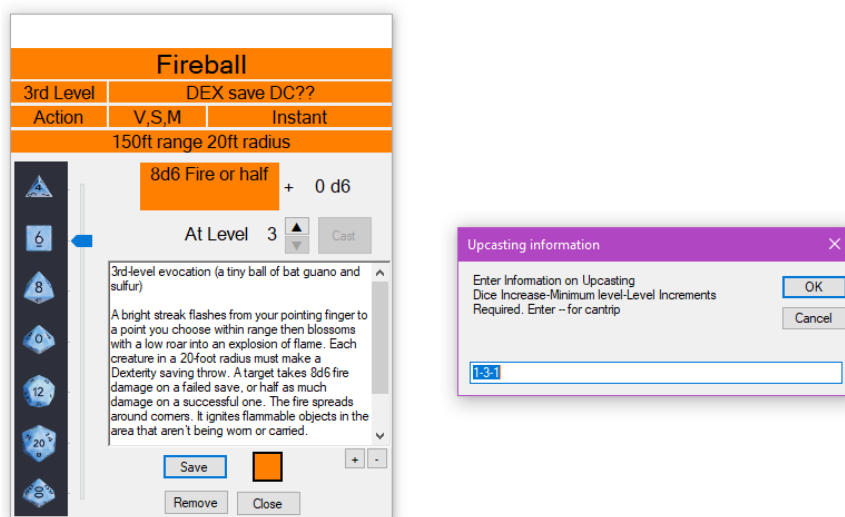


Figure 7:

A few spells are exceptions to this, for example Elemental Weapon and Shadow Blade. Keep those in mind if you use them. Remember, VORTEX isn't designed to teach anyone DND so be sure to familiarise yourself with any spells you use.

Clicking in the box with the spell will bring up the spell's card where the adventurer can edit or clear the box. To create/remove/reorder these slots, right click anywhere in the page. Only a slot that doesn't have a spell written on it can be removed.

2.9 Features

To enter a feature:

1. Right click anywhere on the page and "Add Item". A secondary window will show up

2. Enter the name at the very top textbox. Short description is optional and is a short line of text displayed underneath the name after saving.
3. Enter the full description. Avoid “|”, “:”, and “^”, they will be automatically changed into “_” and “*”
4. This window can be resized like any normal windows. The font can be resized using the “+” and “-” buttons

Once saved, a box will appear in the page with the feature name and short description. Clicking on this box brings up the feature’s card where the adventurer can edit and remove the feature. To reorder features, right click anywhere on the Feature page.

3 Functionalities

3.1 Save and Load

When using VORTEX, it is a good idea to save regularly. To save, click on the “Save” button under the HP and AC panel (see Figure 8):

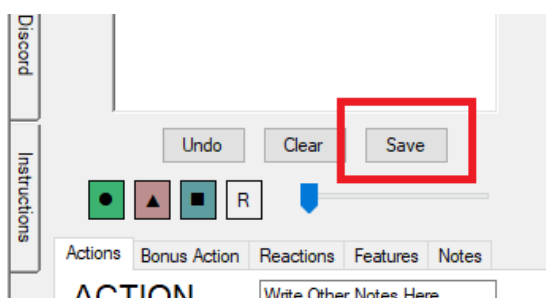


Figure 8:

To Load a file into VORTEX at anytime:

1. Navigate to the Instructions page
2. Close off any Notepad file that is currently open on this page
3. “Open” the desired .txt file.
4. Ensure that the notepad that opened up is the correct file
5. Select “Overwrite Current”

3.2 HP Calculator

When receiving any form of damage and healing:

1. Input the value of HP change into the “Adjust” text box

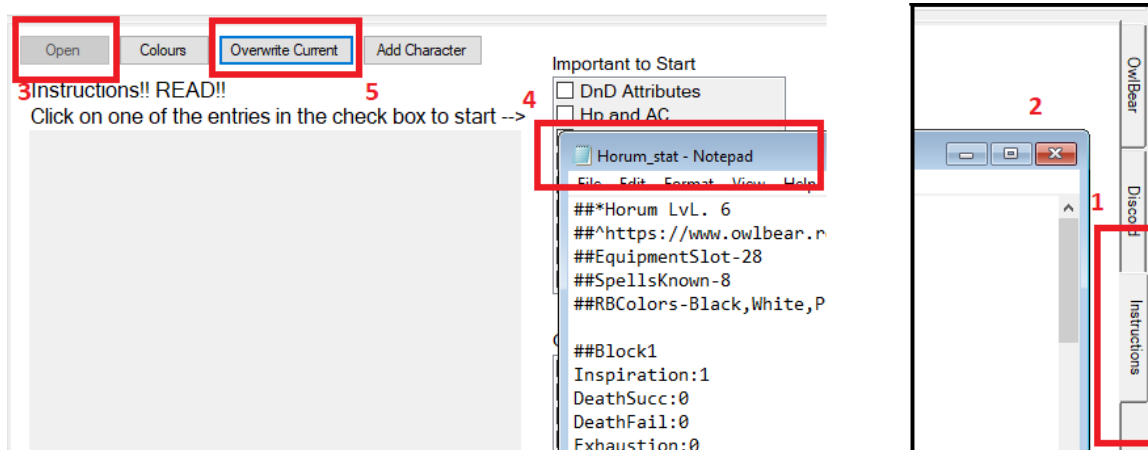


Figure 9:

2. Select from the circle buttons what type of HP change it is (Half and Quarter DMG assumes round up)
3. “Update” and there will be a new log in the text box below

Clicking “Undo” undoes the last HP change as shown in the log. “Clear” cleans up the log

Aid/Max Hp can only work for 1 source at a time. If two values are input subsequently, it will only take the larger number into account. Therefore, if the adventurer got +5 MAX HP from the Aid spell, and +20 MAX HP from Heroes’ Feast for a total of 25, input +25 into the HP calculator instead of +5, then +20

3.3 Gold Calculator - Self

When having any coin exchanges, the adventurer can use the tool in the “Gold” page. To add coins into the total, first enter the sum of coins into “Coins To Self” then click on “Add”

Here are a few notes on how this tool works:

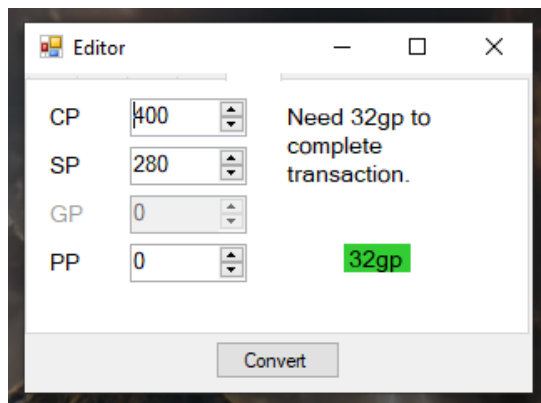
- The format when typing into “Coins To Self” should be in – 33CP 40SP 40GP 2PP – where the value of coin is immediately followed by the denomination and separated by spaces.
- Multiple values of the same denomination is allowed such as – 33cp 20CP 4CP – This is a valid input
- Click on “Add” to add, or “Sub” to remove
- Alternatively, a negative value with “Add” will remove coins. For example – 10CP -20SP – will add 10 copper pieces and remove 20 silver pieces

3.4 Gold Calculator - Conversion

In DnD, 10cp = 1sp, 10sp = 1gp, and 10gp = 1pp. More often than not, adventurers will need to convert their hoard of coins into a higher denomination to lighten their load or tidy up their inventory.

To convert currency in Vortex, type into “Coins To Self” – 1470CP>SP – for example, then click on “Add”.

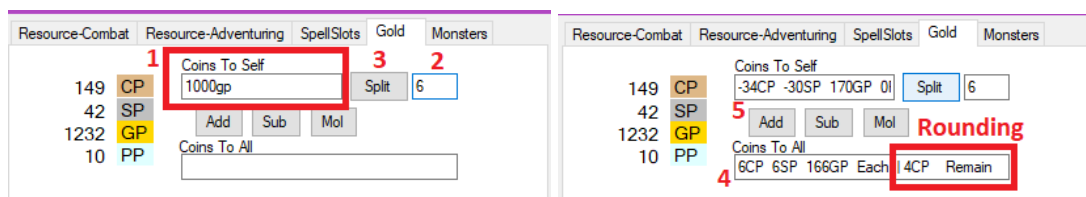
Sometimes, the adventurer does not have sufficient gold pieces, but does have enough copper pieces to cover the cost. In these situations, Vortex understands that the adventurer can pay for it by converting on the spot. A edit box as shown in Figure 3.4 will appear. Simply change the amount of other denominations until the required amount is hit.



3.5 Gold Calculator - Splitting Gold

If the adventurer is in a party that believes in splitting gold fairly, they can do so by the following (see Figure 3.5):

1. Type the total sum of gold into “Coins To Self” box as per usual
2. Enter the size of the party into the box next to “Split” (include yourself in the count)
3. Click on “Split” and a line of text will appear in “Coins To All”.
4. Share this line to the party
5. The sum of coins in “Coins To Self” will have also updated for the adventurer themselves. So click on “Add” to update.



Here are a few notes on splitting gold:

- If the adventurer is splitting gold when the party size is not divisible by 5 or 2, there will be rounding error

- The tool is designed to minimise gold loss through rounding error by breaking down until a copper piece remainder. This is the “CP Remain” text. Feel free to note this down (using the Notes in Section 3.12 for example) and split it when the adventurer have enough for an even split
- Just as the adventurer can split gold earned evenly, they can also split gold to pay evenly. The only difference is clicking on “Sub” at the end of the steps. (negative coin inputs might not work accurately)
- “Mol” is a way to split gold among the party but excluding yourself in the count for the rounding error, which leads to a small loss on your part when compared to other party members. Mol is a silly Hrafn that doesn’t pay too much attention to gold

3.6 Resource Button Colours

VORTEX aims to be customisable, and this holds true for the resource buttons tracking Inspiration, Death Saves, Exhaustion, Combat Resources, Adventuring Resources, and Spell Slots.

To change the colour scheme:

1. Navigate to the Instruction page
2. Click on “Colours” and a secondary window will appear
3. Select the desired colours from options available in the four drop down boxes.
4. Save when done

3.7 Monster AC and HP tracker

Items in this box uses a separate save file. The intention of this page is for players to have a space to note down AC of monsters and the damage the monsters have taken. Most DMs will also call out “That monster is now bloodied”, or “That guy is not looking too good” as a way to signal the half hp threshold. Naturally, DND players roughly keeping track of damage dealt to monsters can double that number in their head and get a rough estimate to the HP of the monster. This tracker also allows for it.

Keep in mind that this combat tool is meant for Combat-to-combat estimation. Remember that the DM always has the freedom to tweak stat blocks during or out of combat for any story telling purposes. Do NOT use this tool as a way to define Monster HP in any campaign.

Here are some notes on how to use the tool:

- To input a monster, Right click on a black space and “Add Monster”. In the subsequent pop-up windows, enter a name and AC.
- Whenever it has taken damage, or when the adventurer get an update to its AC, right click the monster’s name and use the drop down menu
- When the monster is bloodied, the adventurer can update the status from ‘Healthy’ to ‘Bloodied’
- Continue hitting the monster harder than it hits you until it can’t hit you anymore

To remove a monster, right click on the monster's name. To save this list of monsters into VORTEX, right click on a blank space and "Save". The adventurer can also right click on a blank space and "Load Previous" to bring back the previous save file.

3.8 Attack Modifiers and Chance to Hit

Attack rolls are the bread and butter of Martial's, and knowing your chances is crucial in deciding how reckless you need to be. After setting up your weapon attacks in the Action, Bonus Action and Reaction pages, you have two ways to interact with them.

For any temporary changes to attack modifiers, for example any campaign using a +2 to flanking, you can use the "Melee Hit Mod" and "Range Hit Mod" text boxes. Any changes to melee modifiers will be highlighted with blue text, and any changes to range modifiers will be in red text.

If you have a monster listed in the monster page, you can select the monster you are attacking, then hover over your weapon's to hit number. A tool tip will then show up informing you of the chance to land a hit with advantage and disadvantage.

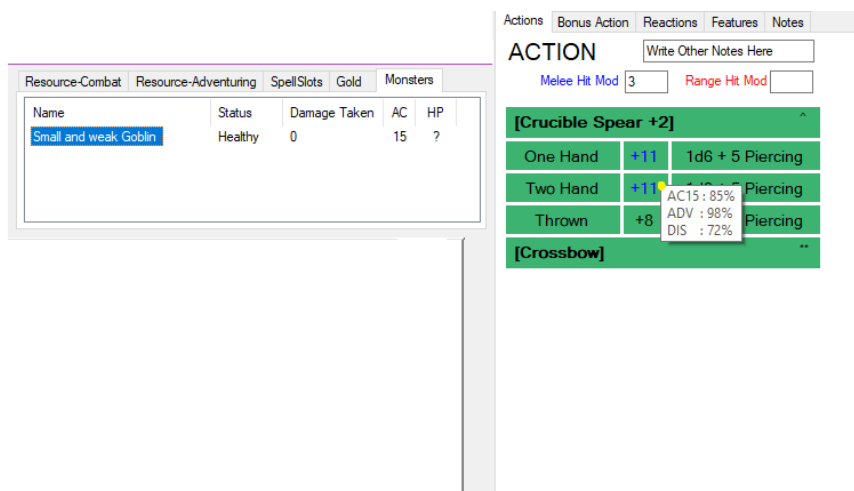
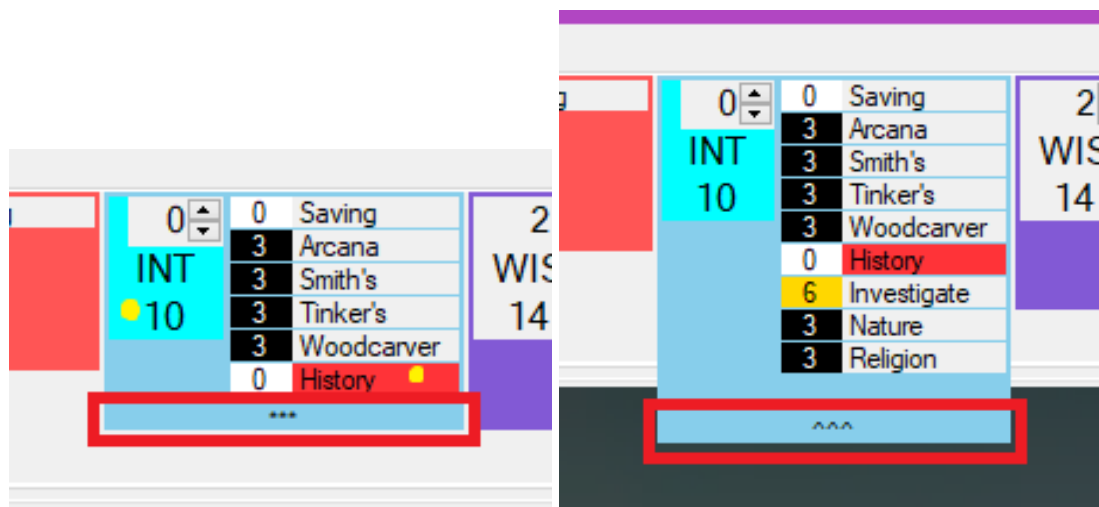


Figure 10:

3.9 General Usage of Attributes Page

Here are some notes on the Attribute page where you see your ability scores and skills (see Figure 3.9):

- While there is a size limit, you can still input more skills than the limit, and expand the coloured boxes by clicking on the '***'
- Your skill modifier has an up and down arrow to it. You can use this to record temporary modifier changes, and it will update to all your skills accordingly
- Clicking on the ability score name, and the box immediately surrounding it will flick between GREY = NORMAL, BLUE = ADVANTAGE, RED = DISADVANTAGE
- Clicking on the skill label will flick between GREY = NORMAL, BLUE = ADVANTAGE, RED = DISADVANTAGE



3.10 Spell Casting

Casting a spell in combat should be like “dropping a LvL 5 Fireball and turn away from the explosion of 10d6s”, and erasing a spell slot shouldn’t be something a powerful wizard have to do manually. As such, this is automated in VORTEX.

To cast any levelled spell and automatically expend the spell slot (following is example using Fireball):

1. Make sure the upcasting information is not set to cantrip “—” and have numbers in between the “-”. Fireball is “1-3-1”
2. Make sure the SpellSlots page is correctly set up, just like the example below
3. Click on Fireball in your spell page to bring up the spell card
4. Use the up and down arrows to choose the level you want to cast it on
5. Hit “Cast”

3.11 Discord

In the spirit of reducing alt-tabbing, Mol also found a way to put discord in VORTEX. Using this functionality is optional but if you only have 1 screen, it could be handy.

To put Discord into VORTEX:

1. Launch Discord normally
2. Navigate to the Discord Page in the program
3. Click on Embed Discord. This grabs the discord window and puts it into this page.

To close discord at any time, use the “Close” button on this page. Exiting VORTEX will also safely close off Discord.

If VORTEX closes without first closing off discord (shouldn’t happen normally), there is a chance that discord will appear broken and you will be unable to launch it anymore. Restarting your computer should fix this.

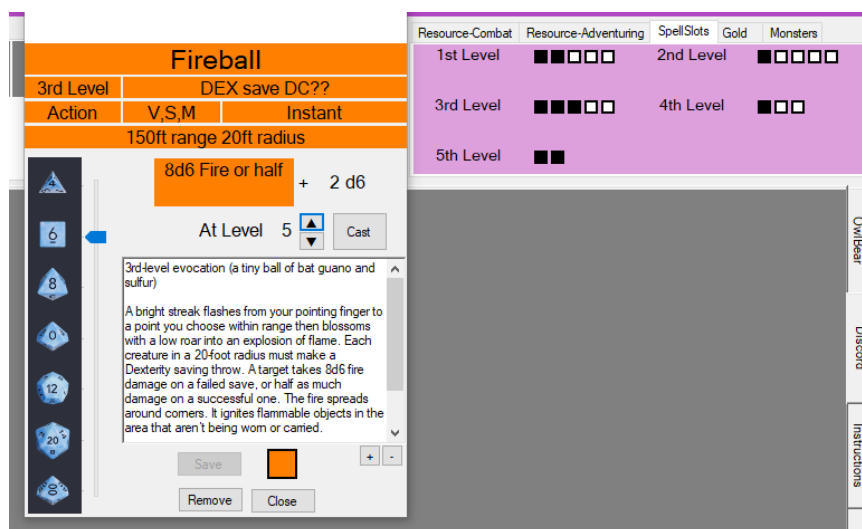


Figure 11:

3.12 Notes

DND players *always* take notes. So in the spirit of reducing alt-tabbing, VORTEX comes with sticky notes you can litter all over.

- Navigate to the Notes page, and right click in the blank spaces to “Add Note”. A sticky note will appear for you to write on. When done, press the “x” button
- The notes is stored and can be brought up again by selecting the boxes in the Notes page
- Right click on the note boxes to remove

3.13 Layout

VORTEX can switch between left and right orientation using the “Invert Layout” button under the “Instructions” Page.

VORTEX can also switch to “In-Person Mode” to half the screen size and removing the large panel for OwlBear and Discord.

For some reasons, these buttons do not respond the first time you click on them, so click on them again!

3.14 Reporting Bugs and Submitting Feedback

No In-Built functions for these. Feel free to email me on iwanpeace.notwar@gmail.com